Vertical Privilege Escalation Incident Report

Kestrel Manufacturing Corp - erp.kestrelmfg.local

Source log file: 03_privilege_escalation_kestrel_manufacturing.log
Report generated: 2026-08-22 11:04:19
Generated by: Log Analysis Toolkit

CRITICAL: 107 accounts self-escalated to admin, 23 rogue admin accounts created, 22 payroll records tampered

Executive Summary

Log lines analyzed	2,500
Bulk IDOR attempts against /api/users/self/role	901
Successful self-escalations	107 (11.9% of attempts)
Denied admin-area recon probes	3
Rogue admin accounts created	23
Unauthorized finance portal accesses	23
Payroll fraud anomalies	22
Audit-log deletion attempts (blocked)	1
Accounts disabled by incident response	19

Bulk Automated IDOR Sweep

A leaked internal API token dump was used to script the broken self-role-change endpoint against every employee account. Most tokens were stale and denied, but a meaningful fraction were still valid, each producing an immediate role escalation.

Total attempts	901
Denied (stale token)	794
Succeeded	107

Accounts Successfully Escalated to Admin

Escalated account
a.achieng
a.gitau3
a.hassan
a.hassan2
a.maina

Escalated account
a.mohamed
a.njoroge3
a.njuguna
a.onyango
a.otieno3
a.waweru
b.akinyi4
b.kiptoo
b.ochieng
b.otieno
b.wanjiru
b.waweru2
c.achieng
c.gitau
c.kariuki2
c.kimani
c.maina
c.njoroge
c.wekesa3
d.kimani3
d.otieno2
d.wanjiru
e.akinyi
e.hassan2
e.mutua
e.njeri2
e.njeri5
e.otieno
e.rotich2
f.karanja2
f.muthoni2
f.wafula2
g.njoroge
g.odhiambo
g.wanjiru

Denied Reconnaissance on Admin Area (pre-escalation probing)

User	Target
j.mwangi77	/admin/users

User	Target
j.mwangi77	/admin/roles
j.mwangi77	/admin/audit-log

Rogue Admin Accounts Created

Created by	New admin account
a.waweru	svc_a.waweru_bak
t.kiprotich	svc_t.kiprotich_bak
m.kiptoo	svc_m.kiptoo_bak
d.otieno2	svc_d.otieno2_bak
a.onyango	svc_a.onyango_bak
w.akinyi	svc_w.akinyi_bak
y.wanjiru2	svc_y.wanjiru2_bak
j.mwangi2	svc_j.mwangi2_bak
d.kimani3	svc_d.kimani3_bak
a.mohamed	svc_a.mohamed_bak
s.mwangi3	svc_s.mwangi3_bak
s.wanjiru	svc_s.wanjiru_bak
f.wafula2	svc_f.wafula2_bak
o.gitau2	svc_o.gitau2_bak
i.chepkoech	svc_i.chepkoech_bak
g.wanjiru	svc_g.wanjiru_bak
m.odhiambo2	svc_m.odhiambo2_bak
r.njeri3	svc_r.njeri3_bak
m.rotich	svc_m.rotich_bak
h.chepkoech	svc_h.chepkoech_bak
j.mwangi77	svc_backup_admin28
j.mwangi77	helpdesk_temp65
j.mwangi77	n.chebet29

Unauthorized Finance Portal Access

Time	User	Target
2026-08-03 00:45:47	a.waweru	/finance/payroll
2026-08-03 00:54:25	t.kiprotich	/finance/payroll
2026-08-03 00:54:58	m.kiptoo	/finance/payroll
2026-08-03 00:55:10	d.otieno2	/finance/payroll
2026-08-03 00:55:40	a.onyango	/finance/payroll
2026-08-03 00:58:33	w.akinyi	/finance/payroll
2026-08-03 00:58:35	y.wanjiru2	/finance/payroll

2026-08-03 01:00:44	j.mwangi2	/finance/payroll
2026-08-03 01:02:43	d.kimani3	/finance/payroll
2026-08-03 01:04:50	a.mohamed	/finance/payroll
2026-08-03 01:05:05	s.mwangi3	/finance/payroll
2026-08-03 01:05:13	s.wanjiru	/finance/payroll
2026-08-03 01:09:32	f.wafula2	/finance/payroll
2026-08-03 01:10:56	o.gitau2	/finance/payroll
2026-08-03 01:22:49	i.chepkoech	/finance/payroll
2026-08-03 01:23:10	g.wanjiru	/finance/payroll
2026-08-03 01:23:27	m.odhiambo2	/finance/payroll
2026-08-03 01:26:22	r.njeri3	/finance/payroll
2026-08-03 01:29:01	m.rotich	/finance/payroll
2026-08-03 01:30:55	h.chepkoech	/finance/payroll

Payroll Fraud Anomalies

user=a.waweru | role=admin | action=UPDATE_PAYROLL_RECORD | employee_id=EMP-1284 | field=salary | old_value=57444 | new_value_delta=+18634 | src_ip=10.20.99.201 | result=SUCCESS_200 | ANOMALY_SELF_MODIFY

user=t.kiprotich | role=admin | action=UPDATE_PAYROLL_RECORD | employee_id=EMP-6271 | field=salary | old_value=45381 | new_value_delta=+37127 | src_ip=10.20.99.201 | result=SUCCESS_200 | ANOMALY_SELF_MODIFY

user=m.kiptoo | role=admin | action=UPDATE_PAYROLL_RECORD | employee_id=EMP-8724 | field=salary | old_value=38528 | new_value_delta=+54989 | src_ip=10.20.99.201 | result=SUCCESS_200 | ANOMALY_SELF_MODIFY

user=d.otieno2 | role=admin | action=UPDATE_PAYROLL_RECORD | employee_id=EMP-3391 | field=salary | old_value=45295 | new_value_delta=+21540 | src_ip=10.20.99.201 | result=SUCCESS_200 | ANOMALY_SELF_MODIFY

user=a.onyango | role=admin | action=UPDATE_PAYROLL_RECORD | employee_id=EMP-3352 | field=salary | old_value=58021 | new_value_delta=+52522 | src_ip=10.20.99.201 | result=SUCCESS_200 | ANOMALY_SELF_MODIFY

user=w.akinyi | role=admin | action=UPDATE_PAYROLL_RECORD | employee_id=EMP-5679 | field=salary | old_value=41980 | new_value_delta=+88441 | src_ip=10.20.99.201 | result=SUCCESS_200 | ANOMALY_SELF_MODIFY

user=y.wanjiru2 | role=admin | action=UPDATE_PAYROLL_RECORD | employee_id=EMP-3537 | field=salary | old_value=54269 | new_value_delta=+70206 | src_ip=10.20.99.201 | result=SUCCESS_200 | ANOMALY_SELF_MODIFY

user=j.mwangi2 | role=admin | action=UPDATE_PAYROLL_RECORD | employee_id=EMP-6159 | field=salary | old_value=52166 | new_value_delta=+34136 | src_ip=10.20.99.201 | result=SUCCESS_200 | ANOMALY_SELF_MODIFY

user=d.kimani3 | role=admin | action=UPDATE_PAYROLL_RECORD | employee_id=EMP-7308 | field=salary | old_value=41168 | new_value_delta=+23737 | src_ip=10.20.99.201 | result=SUCCESS_200 | ANOMALY_SELF_MODIFY

user=a.mohamed | role=admin | action=UPDATE_PAYROLL_RECORD | employee_id=EMP-7513 | field=salary |

old_value=39436 | new_value_delta=+72509 | src_ip=10.20.99.201 | result=SUCCESS_200 | ANOMALY_SELF_MODIFY

user=s.mwangi3 | role=admin | action=UPDATE_PAYROLL_RECORD | employee_id=EMP-1509 | field=salary | old_value=47349 | new_value_delta=+84541 | src_ip=10.20.99.201 | result=SUCCESS_200 | ANOMALY_SELF_MODIFY

user=s.wanjiru | role=admin | action=UPDATE_PAYROLL_RECORD | employee_id=EMP-8204 | field=salary | old_value=49443 | new_value_delta=+83042 | src_ip=10.20.99.201 | result=SUCCESS_200 | ANOMALY_SELF_MODIFY

user=f.wafula2 | role=admin | action=UPDATE_PAYROLL_RECORD | employee_id=EMP-9415 | field=salary | old_value=57287 | new_value_delta=+84988 | src_ip=10.20.99.201 | result=SUCCESS_200 | ANOMALY_SELF_MODIFY

user=o.gitau2 | role=admin | action=UPDATE_PAYROLL_RECORD | employee_id=EMP-2460 | field=salary | old_value=45764 | new_value_delta=+81657 | src_ip=10.20.99.201 | result=SUCCESS_200 | ANOMALY_SELF_MODIFY

user=i.chepkoech | role=admin | action=UPDATE_PAYROLL_RECORD | employee_id=EMP-6466 | field=salary | old_value=35747 | new_value_delta=+19570 | src_ip=10.20.99.201 | result=SUCCESS_200 | ANOMALY_SELF_MODIFY

Cover-Up Attempt

2026-08-03 01:38:47 | user=j.mwangi77 | role=admin | action=DELETE_AUDIT_LOG | range=last_2_hours | src_ip=10.20.4.118 | result=DENIED_403_IMMUTABLE_LOG

Incident Response

2026-08-03 01:41:48 | user=SYSTEM | action=SECURITY_ALERT | severity=critical | msg="Bulk privilege escalation detected via /api/users/self/role: 106 accounts self-elevated to admin, 20 used for payroll fraud, actor j.mwangi77 created rogue admin accounts and a duplicate payroll identity" | result=ACCOUNT_DISABLED

Disabled account
j.mwangi77
svc_backup_admin28
helpdesk_temp65
n.chebet29
a.mohamed
t.kiprotich
o.gitau2
f.wafula2
i.chepkoech
d.kimani3
d.otieno2
m.rotich
w.akinyi
y.wanjiru2
j.mwangi2
s.wanjiru

Disabled account
a.waweru
h.chepkoech
a.onyango